

Cybersecurity Incident Response Policy

Meridian Global Corp — Confidential Internal Document

****Cybersecurity Incident Response Policy****

Policy Statement and Purpose

Meridian Global Corp is committed to maintaining the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of its information systems and data assets. This Cybersecurity Incident Response Policy establishes a robust framework for identifying, containing, eradicating, recovering from, and reviewing cybersecurity incidents. Its purpose is to minimize the impact of security incidents on Meridian Global Corp operations, reputation, and stakeholders, ensuring prompt and effective responses in compliance with applicable laws and regulations. Adherence to this policy is mandatory for all employees, contractors, and third parties with access to Meridian Global Corp systems or data.

Scope

This policy applies to all cybersecurity incidents affecting Meridian Global Corp's global infrastructure, information systems, applications, data, and personnel, regardless of location or the device used. It covers all forms of security breaches, service disruptions, and policy violations that could impact the security posture of the corporation.

Incident Prioritization and Response Tiers

Cybersecurity incidents are categorized into four tiers based on their potential impact and urgency. Response times are measured from the moment an incident is officially declared.

* ****P1 Critical Incidents:****

* ****Description:**** Incidents involving confirmed data breaches of sensitive corporate or customer data (e.g., PII, intellectual property), active ransomware attacks, or widespread critical service outages. These incidents pose an immediate and severe threat to Meridian Global Corp's operations, legal standing, or reputation.

* ****Response Time:**** 15 minutes to initiate active response and CISO escalation.

* ****Escalation:**** Immediate notification to Dr. Evelyn Reed (CISO), Ms. Sophia Chen (Head of Legal), and the Executive Leadership Team.

* ****P2 High Incidents:****

* ****Description:**** Incidents involving unauthorized access to critical systems, significant system compromise without confirmed data exfiltration, widespread malware outbreaks, or disruption of key business functions.

- * **Response Time:** 1 hour to initiate active response and CISO escalation.
- * **Escalation:** Notification to Dr. Evelyn Reed (CISO) and relevant department heads.
- * **P3 Medium Incidents:**
- * **Description:** Incidents involving isolated malware detection on non-critical systems, persistent but unsuccessful attempts at unauthorized access, minor system misconfigurations identified by monitoring, or internal policy violations with potential security implications.
- * **Response Time:** 4 hours to initiate active response.
- * **Escalation:** Notification to Mr. Arjun Singh (SOC Lead) and relevant system owners. CISO to be informed for awareness.
- * **P4 Low Incidents:**
- * **Description:** Incidents involving minor policy violations without immediate security impact (e.g., unauthorized software installation on a non-critical workstation, reported phishing attempts that were blocked), or anomalous activity requiring further investigation.
- * **Response Time:** 5 business days to initiate investigation.
- * **Escalation:** Notification to departmental manager and the Security Operations Center (SOC) team.

Incident Reporting and Initial Triage

All potential cybersecurity incidents must be reported immediately via the dedicated Security Incident Hotline (+1-800-MERIDIAN) or via email to security.incidents@meridianglobal.com. The Security Operations Center (SOC) is responsible for initial triage, categorization, and assignment to the appropriate response team.

Incident Response Protocols

Meridian Global Corp follows a structured incident response lifecycle:

1. **Detection and Analysis:** Identify, verify, and assess the scope and nature of the incident.
 2. **Containment:** Implement strategies to limit the impact of the incident.
- * **Isolate Affected Systems:** Immediately disconnect or segregate compromised systems, networks, or applications to prevent further propagation of the attack. This may involve network segmentation, firewall rule adjustments, or system shutdown where appropriate.

* **Preserve Logs and Forensic Evidence:** Ensure all relevant logs (system, application, network, authentication) and system images are secured and preserved for forensic analysis. This is critical for understanding the attack vector, root cause, and for potential legal proceedings.

* **Notify Legal Department:** Ms. Sophia Chen (Head of Legal) or her delegate must be informed promptly regarding incidents, particularly P1 and P2 events, to assess potential legal and regulatory implications.

3. **Eradication:** Eliminate the root cause of the incident and remove all malicious components.

4. **Recovery:** Restore affected systems and services to operational status, ensuring integrity and functionality.

5. **Post-Incident Activity:** Conduct a thorough review of the incident and implement lessons learned.

Regulatory Notification

For **P1 Critical Incidents**, Meridian Global Corp's Legal Department, in conjunction with the CISO's office, is responsible for fulfilling all mandatory regulatory reporting obligations. This includes notifying relevant Computer Emergency Response Teams (CERTs) as required by jurisdiction. Specifically, for operations within India, notification to CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team) must be completed within **6 hours of discovery** of a P1 Critical Incident. Similar obligations apply in other operating regions.

Roles and Responsibilities

* **CISO (Dr. Evelyn Reed):** Overall accountability for incident response strategy, policy, and executive communication.

* **Security Operations Center (SOC) (Mr. Arjun Singh):** 24/7 monitoring, initial triage, incident handling, and technical response coordination.

* **Legal Department (Ms. Sophia Chen):** Regulatory compliance, legal advice, and external notifications.

* **IT Operations:** System recovery, patching, and infrastructure support.

* **Corporate Communications:** Management of external and internal communications regarding incidents.

* **Human Resources:** Addressing personnel-related security violations.

Post-Incident Review (PIR)

A formal Post-Incident Review (PIR) is mandatory for all P1 Critical and P2 High incidents. The PIR must be initiated within **5 business days** of the incident's resolution. The review will analyze the incident's cause, the effectiveness of the response, identify lessons learned, and recommend improvements to policies, procedures, and technologies. Findings and actionable recommendations will be documented and tracked for implementation.

Policy Governance

* **Version:** 1.2

* **Effective Date:** 15 August 2024

* **Review Date:** This policy will be reviewed annually, or as necessitated by significant changes in the threat landscape, regulatory requirements, or organizational structure.

* **Approval:** Dr. Evelyn Reed, CISO, Meridian Global Corp